T LEVEL GUIDE

Educator briefing

For teachers and careers advisers: the key facts about T Levels, some questions to start the conversation, and where to point students next.

The key facts

- T Levels are 2-year, Level 3 courses, the same size as 3 A levels.
- Students spend about 80% of their time in the classroom and 20% on an industry placement.
- The placement is at least 315 hours, which is about 45 days.
- Each school or college sets its own entry requirements.
- Students get an overall grade of pass, merit, distinction or distinction*.

Starting the conversation

These questions help students think about whether a T Level suits the way they like to learn.

- Which subjects do you enjoy most, and what is it about them you like?
- Do you prefer hands-on, practical work, or exams and essays?
- How would you feel about spending time in a real workplace while you study?
- Are there any jobs or areas of work you're curious about?

Helping students decide

- Encourage them to go to open days and ask how placements are organised.
- Look at T Levels, A levels and apprenticeships side by side, so they can see the differences.
- If a student isn't ready yet, the T Level Foundation Year could be a good first step.

Useful links

- TLevels.gov.uk, written for students and parents: www.tlevels.gov.uk
- GOV.UK, Introduction of T Levels: www.gov.uk/government/publications/introduction-of-t-levels
- GOV.UK, industry placements guidance: www.gov.uk/government/publications/t-level-industry-placements-guidance-for-providers

Information from TLevels.gov.uk and GOV.UK, correct in October 2026.